

The Gospel According to John

The Beginning

Genesis 1:1-2; Hebrews 11:1-3



¹In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.

²He was with God in the beginning. ³Through Him all things were made, and without Him nothing was made that has been made. ⁴In Him was life, and that life was the light of men. ⁵The Light shines in the darkness, and the darkness has not overcome^a it.

The Witness of John

⁶There came a man who was sent from God. His name was John. ⁷He came as a witness to testify about the Light, so that through him everyone might believe. ⁸He himself was not the Light, but he came to testify about the Light.

⁵⁰ Jesus said to him, “Do you believe just because I told you I saw you under the fig tree? You will see greater things than these.”
⁵¹ Then He declared, “Truly, truly, I tell you, you will all see heaven open and the angels of God ascending and descending on the Son of Man.”^a

The Wedding at Cana



¹ On the third day a wedding took place at Cana in Galilee. Jesus' mother was there,

² and Jesus and His disciples had also been invited to the wedding.
³ When the wine ran out, Jesus' mother said to Him, “They have no more wine.”

⁴ “Woman, what is that to you and to Me?” Jesus replied. “My hour has not yet come.”

⁵ His mother said to the servants, “Do whatever He tells you.”

⁶ Now six stone water jars had been set there for the Jewish rites of purification. Each could hold from twenty to thirty gallons.^b

⁷ Jesus told the servants, “Fill the jars with water.”

So they filled them to the brim.

⁸ “Now draw some out,” He said, “and take it to the master of the banquet.”

They did so, ⁹ and the master of the banquet tasted the water

will raise it up again.

²⁰“This temple took forty-six years to build,” the Jews replied, “and You are going to raise it up in three days?”

²¹But Jesus was speaking about the temple of His body. ²²After He was raised from the dead, His disciples remembered that He had said this. Then they believed the Scripture and the word that Jesus had spoken.

²³While He was in Jerusalem at the Passover Feast, many people saw the signs He was doing and believed in His name. ²⁴But Jesus did not entrust Himself to them, for He knew them all. ²⁵He did not need any testimony about man, for He knew what was in a man.

Jesus and Nicodemus

Genesis 22:1–10; Romans 5:6–11



¹Now there was a man of the Pharisees named Nicodemus, a leader of the Jews.

²He came to Jesus at night and said, “Rabbi, we know that You are a teacher who has come from God. For no one could perform the signs You are doing if God were not with him.”

³Jesus replied, “Truly, truly, I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless he is born again.^b”

⁴“How can a man be born when he is old?” Nicodemus asked. “Can he enter his mother’s womb a second time to be born?”

⁵Jesus answered, “Truly, truly, I tell you, no one can enter the

and it is now complete. ³⁰He must increase; I must decrease.

³¹The One who comes from above is above all. The one who is from the earth belongs to the earth and speaks as one from the earth. The One who comes from heaven is above all.^a ³²He testifies to what He has seen and heard, yet no one accepts His testimony. ³³Whoever accepts His testimony has certified that God is truthful. ³⁴For the One whom God has sent speaks the words of God, for God gives the Spirit without limit.

³⁵The Father loves the Son and has placed all things in His hands. ³⁶Whoever believes in the Son has eternal life. Whoever rejects the Son will not see life. Instead, the wrath of God remains on him.”^b

Jesus and the Samaritan Woman



¹ When Jesus realized that the Pharisees were aware He^c was gaining and baptizing more disciples than John

² (although it was not Jesus who baptized, but His disciples), ³ He left Judea and returned to Galilee.

⁴ Now He had to pass through Samaria. ⁵ So He came to a town of Samaria called Sychar, near the plot of ground that Jacob had given to his son Joseph. ⁶ Since Jacob's well was there, Jesus, weary from His journey, sat down by the well. It was about the sixth hour.^d

⁷ When a Samaritan woman came to draw water, Jesus said to her, “**Give Me a drink.**” ⁸ (His disciples had gone into the town to buy food.)

The Pool of Bethesda

5

¹ Some time later there was a feast of the Jews, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.

² Now there is in Jerusalem near the Sheep Gate a pool with five covered colonnades, which in Hebrew^a is called Bethesda.^b ³ On these walkways^c lay a great number of the sick, the blind, the lame, and the paralyzed.^d

⁵ One man there had been an invalid for thirty-eight years. ⁶ When Jesus saw him lying there and realized that he had spent a long time in this condition, He asked him, “**Do you want to get well?**”

⁷ “Sir,” the invalid replied, “I have no one to help me into the pool when the water is stirred. While I am on my way, someone else goes in before me.”

⁸ Then Jesus told him, “**Get up, pick up your mat, and walk.**”

⁹ Immediately the man was made well, and he picked up his mat and began to walk.

Now this happened on the Sabbath day, ¹⁰ so the Jews said to the man who had been healed, “This is the Sabbath! It is unlawful for you to carry your mat.”

¹¹ But he answered, “The man who made me well told me, ‘**Pick up your mat and walk.**’”

¹² “Who is this man who told you to pick it up and walk?” they asked

⁴¹ I do not accept glory from men, ⁴² but I know you, that you do not have the love of God within you. ⁴³ I have come in My Father's name, and you have not received Me; but if someone else comes in his own name, you will receive him. ⁴⁴ How can you believe if you accept glory from one another, yet do not seek the glory that comes from the only God?

⁴⁵ Do not think that I will accuse you before the Father. Your accuser is Moses, in whom you have put your hope. ⁴⁶ If you had believed Moses, you would believe Me, because he wrote about Me. ⁴⁷ But since you do not believe what he wrote, how will you believe what I say?"

The Feeding of the Five Thousand

Matthew 14:13-21; Mark 6:30-44; Luke 9:10-17



¹After this, Jesus crossed to the other side of the Sea of Galilee (that is, the Sea of Tiberias).

²A large crowd followed Him because they saw the signs He was performing on the sick. ³Then Jesus went up on the mountain and sat down with His disciples.

⁴Now the Jewish Feast of the Passover was near. ⁵When Jesus looked up and saw a large crowd coming toward Him, He said to Philip, "Where can we buy bread for these people to eat?" ⁶But He was asking this to test him, for He knew what He was about to do.

⁷Philip answered, "Two hundred denarii^a would not buy enough bread for each of them to have a small piece."

Jesus Teaches at the Feast



¹ After this, Jesus traveled throughout Galilee. He did not want to travel in Judea, because the Jews there were trying to kill Him.

² However, the Jewish Feast of Tabernacles^a was near. ³ So Jesus' brothers said to Him, "Leave here and go to Judea, so that Your disciples there may see the works You are doing." ⁴ For no one who wants to be known publicly acts in secret. Since You are doing these things, show Yourself to the world." ⁵ For even His own brothers did not believe in Him.

⁶ Therefore Jesus told them, "Although your time is always at hand, My time has not yet come. ⁷ The world cannot hate you, but it hates Me, because I testify that its works are evil. ⁸ Go up to the feast on your own. I am not^b going up to this feast, because My time has not yet come."

⁹ Having said this, Jesus remained in Galilee. ¹⁰ But after His brothers had gone up to the feast, He also went — not publicly, but in secret.

¹¹ So the Jews were looking for Him at the feast and asking, "Where is He?"

¹² Many in the crowds were whispering about Him. Some said, "He is a good man."

But others replied, "No, He deceives the people."

¹³ Yet no one would speak publicly about Him for fear of

⁴⁵Then the officers returned to the chief priests and Pharisees, who asked them, “Why didn’t you bring Him in?”

⁴⁶“Never has anyone spoken like this man!” the officers answered.

⁴⁷“Have you also been deceived?” replied the Pharisees.
⁴⁸“Have any of the rulers or Pharisees believed in Him? ⁴⁹But this crowd that does not know the law— they are under a curse.”

⁵⁰Nicodemus, who had gone to Jesus earlier and who himself was one of them, asked, ⁵¹“Does our law convict a man without first hearing from him to determine what he has done?”

⁵²“Aren’t you also from Galilee?” they replied. “Look into it, and you will see that no prophet comes out of Galilee.”^b

⁵³Then each went to his own home.

The Woman Caught in Adultery



¹ But Jesus went to the Mount of Olives.

²Early in the morning He went back into the temple courts.^c All the people came to Him, and He sat down to teach them. ³The scribes and Pharisees, however, brought to Him a woman caught in adultery. They made her stand before them ⁴and said, “Teacher, this woman was caught in the act of adultery. ⁵In the Law Moses commanded us to stone such a woman. So what do You say?”

⁶They said this to test Him, in order to have a basis for accusing Him. But Jesus bent down and began to write on the ground

claim to be?”

⁵⁴ Jesus answered, “If I glorify Myself, My glory means nothing. The One who glorifies Me is My Father, of whom you say, ‘He is our^a God.’ ⁵⁵ You do not know Him, but I know Him. If I said I did not know Him, I would be a liar like you. But I do know Him, and I keep His word. ⁵⁶ Your father Abraham rejoiced that he would see My day. He saw it and was glad.”

⁵⁷ Then the Jews said to Him, “You are not yet fifty years old, and You have seen Abraham?”

⁵⁸ “Truly, truly, I tell you,” Jesus declared, “before Abraham was born, I am!^b”

⁵⁹ At this, they picked up stones to throw at Him. But Jesus was hidden and went out of the temple area.^c

Jesus Heals the Man Born Blind



¹ Now as Jesus was passing by, He saw a man blind from birth,

² and His disciples asked Him, “Rabbi, who sinned, this man or his parents, that he was born blind?”

³ Jesus answered, “Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him. ⁴ While it is daytime, we must do^d the works of Him who sent

^a WH and TR *Your* ^b Literally *before Abraham was, I am!* ^c BYZ and TR include *going through the midst of them, and so He passed by.* ^d BYZ and TR *I must do*

Jesus the Good Shepherd

Psalm 23:1–6; Ezekiel 34:11–24



1 “Truly, truly, I tell you, whoever does not enter the sheepfold by the gate, but climbs in some other way, is a thief and a robber.

2 But the one who enters by the gate is the shepherd of the sheep. **3** The gatekeeper opens the gate for him, and the sheep listen for his voice. He calls his own sheep by name and leads them out.

4 When he has brought out all his own, he goes on ahead of them, and his sheep follow him because they know his voice. **5** But they will never follow a stranger; in fact, they will flee from him because they do not recognize his voice.”

6 Jesus spoke to them using this illustration, but they did not understand what He was telling them. **7** So He said to them again, “Truly, truly, I tell you, I am the gate for the sheep. **8** All who came before Me^a were thieves and robbers, but the sheep did not listen to them. **9** I am the gate. If anyone enters through Me, he will be saved. He will come in and go out and find pasture. **10** The thief comes only to steal and kill and destroy. I have come that they may have life, and have it in all its fullness.

11 I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down His life for the sheep. **12** The hired hand is not the shepherd, and the

The Death of Lazarus

11

¹ At this time a man named Lazarus was sick. He lived in Bethany, the village of Mary and her sister Martha.

² (Mary, whose brother Lazarus was sick, was to anoint the Lord with perfume and wipe His feet^a with her hair.) ³ So the sisters sent word to Jesus, “Lord, the one You love is sick.”

⁴ When Jesus heard this, He said, “This sickness will not end in death. No, it is for the glory of God, so that the Son of God may be glorified through it.”

⁵ Now Jesus loved Martha and her sister and Lazarus. ⁶ So on hearing that Lazarus was sick, He stayed where He was for two days, ⁷ and then He said to the disciples, “Let us go back to Judea.”

⁸ “Rabbi,” they replied, “the Jews just tried to stone You, and You are going back there?”

⁹ Jesus answered, “Are there not twelve hours of daylight? If anyone walks in the daytime, he will not stumble, because he sees by the light of this world. ¹⁰ But if anyone walks at night, he will stumble, because he has no light.”

¹¹ After He had said this, He told them, “Our friend Lazarus has fallen asleep, but I am going there to wake him up.”

¹² His disciples replied, “Lord, if he is sleeping, he will get better.” ¹³ They thought that Jesus was talking about actual sleep, but He was speaking about the death of Lazarus.

Mary Anoints Jesus

Matthew 26:6–13; Mark 14:3–9; Luke 7:36–50

12

¹Six days before the Passover, Jesus came to Bethany, the hometown of Lazarus, whom He had raised from the dead.

²So they hosted a dinner for Jesus there. Martha served, and Lazarus was among those reclining at the table with Him. ³Then Mary took about a pint^a of expensive perfume, made of pure nard, and she anointed Jesus' feet and wiped them with her hair. And the house was filled with the fragrance of the perfume.

⁴But one of His disciples, Judas Iscariot, who was going to betray Him, asked, ⁵“Why wasn't this perfume sold for three hundred denarii^b and the money given to the poor?” ⁶Judas did not say this because he cared about the poor, but because he was a thief. As keeper of the money bag, he used to take from what was put into it.

⁷“Leave her alone,” Jesus replied. “She has kept this perfume in preparation for the day of My burial.” ⁸The poor you will always have with you,^c but you will not always have Me.”

The Plot to Kill Lazarus

⁹Meanwhile a large crowd of Jews learned that Jesus was there. And they came not only because of Him, but also to see

that His command leads to eternal life. So I speak exactly what the Father has told Me to say.”

Jesus Washes His Disciples’ Feet

13

¹It was now just before the Passover Feast, and Jesus knew that His hour had come to leave this world and return to the Father. Having loved His own who were in the world, He loved them to the very end.^a

²The evening meal was underway, and the devil had already put into the heart of Judas, the son of Simon Iscariot, to betray Jesus.

³Jesus knew that the Father had delivered all things into His hands, and that He had come from God and was returning to God.

⁴So He got up from the supper, laid aside His outer garments, and wrapped a towel around His waist. ⁵After that, He poured water into a basin and began to wash the disciples’ feet and dry them with the towel that was around Him.

⁶He came to Simon Peter, who asked Him, “Lord, are You going to wash my feet?”

⁷Jesus replied, “You do not realize now what I am doing, but later you will understand.”

⁸“Never shall You wash my feet!” Peter told Him.

Jesus answered, “Unless I wash you, you have no part with Me.”

Jesus Predicts Peter's Denial

Matthew 26:31–35; Mark 14:27–31; Luke 22:31–38

³⁶“Lord, where are You going?” Simon Peter asked.

Jesus answered, “Where I am going, you cannot follow Me now, but you will follow later.”

³⁷“Lord,” said Peter, “why can’t I follow You now? I will lay down my life for You.”

³⁸“Will you lay down your life for Me?” Jesus replied. “Truly, truly, I tell you, before the rooster crows, you will deny Me three times.[”]

In My Father's House Are Many Rooms



¹ “Do not let your hearts be troubled. You believe in God;^a believe in Me as well.

² In My Father's house are many rooms. If it were not so, would I have told you that I am going there to prepare a place for you?

^b ³ And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and welcome you into My presence, so that you also may be where I am.

⁴ You know the way to the place where I am going.^c”

The Way, the Truth, and the Life

⁵“Lord ” said Thomas, “we do not know where You are going

what the Father has commanded Me, so that the world may know that I love the Father.

Get up! Let us go on from here.[”]

Jesus the True Vine

Isaiah 27:1–13



¹ “I am the true vine, and My Father is the keeper of the vineyard.

² He cuts off every branch in Me that bears no fruit, and every branch that does bear fruit, He prunes to make it even more fruitful.

³ You are already clean because of the word I have spoken to you. ⁴ Remain in Me, and I will remain in you. Just as no branch can bear fruit by itself unless it remains in the vine, neither can you bear fruit unless you remain in Me.

⁵ I am the vine and you are the branches. The one who remains in Me, and I in him, will bear much fruit. For apart from Me you can do nothing. ⁶ If anyone does not remain in Me, he is like a branch that is thrown away and withers. Such branches are gathered up, thrown into the fire, and burned. ⁷ If you remain in Me and My words remain in you, ask whatever you wish, and it will

not know who one who sent him. If I had not come and spoken to them, they would not be guilty of sin. Now, however, they have no excuse for their sin.

²³ Whoever hates Me hates My Father as well. ²⁴ If I had not done among them the works that no one else did, they would not be guilty of sin; but now they have seen and hated both Me and My Father. ²⁵ But this is to fulfill what is written in their Law: ‘They hated Me without reason.’^b

²⁶ When the Advocate^c comes, whom I will send to you from the Father — the Spirit of truth who proceeds from the Father — He will testify about Me. ²⁷ And you also must testify, because you have been with Me from the beginning.[”]

Persecution Foretold

Acts 23:12–22



¹ “I have told you these things so that you will not fall away.

² They will put you out of the synagogues. In fact, a time is coming when anyone who kills you will think he is offering a service to God.

³ They will do these things because they have not known the Father or Me. ⁴ But I have told you these things so that when their hour comes, you will remember that I told you about them. I did not tell you these things from the beginning, because I was with you.

have believed that I came from God.”²⁸ I came from the Father and entered the world. In turn, I will leave the world and go to the Father.”

²⁹ His disciples said, “See, now You are speaking plainly and without figures of speech. ³⁰ Now we understand that You know all things and that You have no need for anyone to question You. Because of this, we believe that You came from God.”

³¹ “Do you finally believe?” Jesus replied. ³² “Look, an hour is coming and has already come when you will be scattered, each to his own home, and you will leave Me all alone. Yet I am not alone, because the Father is with Me. ³³ I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!”

Prayer for the Son

17

¹ When Jesus had spoken these things, He lifted up His eyes to heaven and said, “Father, the hour has come. Glorify Your Son, that Your Son may glorify You.

² For You granted Him authority over all people,^b so that He may give eternal life to all those You have given Him. ³ Now this is eternal life, that they may know You, the only true God, and Jesus Christ, whom You have sent. ⁴ I have glorified You on earth by accomplishing the work You gave Me to do. ⁵ And now, Father, glorify Me in Your presence with the glory I had with You before the world existed.

Your name known to them and will continue to make it known, so that the love You have for Me may be in them, and I in them.”

The Betrayal of Jesus

Matthew 26:47–56; Mark 14:43–52; Luke 22:47–53

18

¹After Jesus had spoken these words, He went out with His disciples across the Kidron Valley, where they entered a garden.

²Now Judas His betrayer also knew the place, because Jesus^a had often met there with His disciples. ³So Judas brought a band of soldiers and officers from the chief priests and Pharisees. They arrived at the garden carrying lanterns, torches, and weapons.

⁴Jesus, knowing all that was coming upon Him, stepped forward and asked them, “Whom are you seeking?”

⁵“Jesus of Nazareth,” they answered.

Jesus said, “I am He.”

And Judas His betrayer was standing there with them. ⁶When Jesus said, “I am He,” they drew back and fell to the ground.

⁷So He asked them again, “Whom are you seeking?”

“Jesus of Nazareth,” they answered.

⁸“I told you that I am He,” Jesus replied. “So if you are looking for Me, let these men go.” ⁹This was to fulfill the word He had spoken: “I have not lost one of those You have given Me.”^b

My kingdom is not of this realm.

³⁷“Then You are a king!” Pilate said.

“You say that I am a king,” Jesus answered. “For this reason I was born and have come into the world, to testify to the truth. Everyone who belongs to the truth listens to My voice.”

³⁸“What is truth?” Pilate asked.

And having said this, he went out again to the Jews and told them, “I find no basis for a charge against Him. ³⁹But it is your custom that I release to you one prisoner at the Passover. So then, do you want me to release to you the King of the Jews?”

⁴⁰“Not this man,” they shouted, “but Barabbas!” (Now Barabbas was an insurrectionist.)

The Soldiers Mock Jesus

Isaiah 50:4–11; Matthew 27:27–31; Mark 15:16–20; Luke 22:63–65



¹ Then Pilate took Jesus and had Him flogged.

² The soldiers twisted together a crown of thorns, set it on His head, and dressed Him in a purple robe. ³ And they went up to Him again and again, saying, “Hail, King of the Jews!” and slapping Him in the face.

⁴ Once again Pilate came out and said to the Jews, “Look, I am bringing Him out to you to let you know that I find no basis for a charge against Him.” ⁵ When Jesus came out wearing the crown of thorns and the purple robe, Pilate said to them, “Here is the man!”

⁶ As soon as the chief priests and officers saw Him, they

Jesus (but secretly for fear of the Jews), asked Pilate to let him remove the body of Jesus. Pilate gave him permission, so he came and removed His body. ³⁹ Nicodemus, who had previously come to Jesus at night, also brought a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about seventy-five pounds.^c ⁴⁰ So they took the body of Jesus and wrapped it in linen cloths with the spices, according to the Jewish burial custom.

⁴¹ Now there was a garden in the place where Jesus was crucified, and in the garden a new tomb in which no one had yet been laid. ⁴² And because it was the Jewish day of Preparation and the tomb was nearby, they placed Jesus there.

The Resurrection

Matthew 28:1–10; Mark 16:1–8; Luke 24:1–12

20

¹ Early on the first day of the week,^d while it was still dark, Mary Magdalene went to the tomb and saw that the stone had been removed from the entrance.

² So she came running to Simon Peter and the other disciple, the one whom Jesus loved. “They have taken the Lord out of the tomb,” she said, “and we do not know where they have put Him!”

³ Then Peter and the other disciple set out for the tomb. ⁴ The two were running together, but the other disciple outran Peter and reached the tomb first. ⁵ He bent down and looked in at the linen cloths lying there, but he did not go in.

⁶ Simon Peter arrived just after him. He entered the tomb and

27 Then Jesus said to Thomas, “Put your finger here and look at My hands. Reach out your hand and put it into My side. Stop doubting and believe.”

28 Thomas replied, “My Lord and my God!”

29 Jesus said to him, “Because you have seen Me, you have believed; blessed are those who have not seen and yet have believed.”

The Purpose of John's Book

30 Jesus performed many other signs in the presence of His disciples, which are not written in this book. 31 But these are written so that you may believe^a that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and that by believing you may have life in His name.

Jesus Appears by the Sea of Tiberias

21

1 Later, by the Sea of Tiberias,^b Jesus again revealed Himself to the disciples. He made Himself known in this way:

2 Simon Peter, Thomas called Didymus,^c Nathanael from Cana in Galilee, the sons of Zebedee, and two other disciples were together.

3 Simon Peter told them, “I am going fishing.”

“We will go with you,” they said. So they went out and got into the boat, but caught nothing that night.

4 Early in the morning, Jesus stood on the shore, but the disciples did not recognize that it was Jesus. 5 So He called out to them, “Children, do you have any fish?”

“No,” they answered.